Ankit Bhutani

420 West 118th St, New York, NY 10027

ab4462@columbia.edu

EDUCATION

Columbia University, New York, NY
Ph.D. in Economics — 2022 – 2028 (Expected)

London School of Economics and Political Science, London, UK
M.Sc. Econometrics and Mathematical Economics (Distinction) — 2021 – 2022

Columbia University, New York, NY
M.A. Economics — 2019 – 2020

Indian Institute of Technology, Kanpur, India
Integrated B.Tech.–M.Tech. in Electrical Engineering — 2009 – 2014

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Macroeconomics, Production Networks , Information Frictions, Corporate Finance

WORKING PAPERS

The Missing Value of Data (with Guillermo Ordoñez and Laura Veldkamp)

Data assets are increasingly vital in modern economies, yet macroeconomic measurement is not well-adapted to capturing its value. Part of the problem is that data is an intangible asset: investments in data are missed in national accounts and losses due to depreciation are missed in firms' balance sheets. Another problem, unique to data, is that it constitutes means of payment in the modern economy: consumption bartered for data is also missed in national accounts. We propose an output-based approach to measure the missing value of data. We treat data as an asset, measure it with the quality of firms' revenue forecasts, and endogenously determine its depreciation. We then capitalize data value and explore what measured GDP would be if data were treated and transacted similarly to a physical asset. Our findings suggest that the aggregate value of data is about 3% of GDP, increasing in the last decade to around 4.5%.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Market Power and Risk Sharing in Production Networks

I study the role of trade credit in production networks when trade credit terms are determined endogenously as part of an optimal risk-sharing contract between suppliers and buyers. A supplier with market power extends trade credit by borrowing against her own profits, exposing herself to the buyer's demand risk in exchange for higher procurement volume. Market power shapes trade credit provision through two opposing forces: greater market power reduces the need to extend credit to attract buyers, but higher profits lower the supplier's cost of capital, making credit cheaper to provide. I explore how the resolution of this trade-off determines trade credit volume across the network and shapes the economy's response to demand and financial shocks, in contrast to frameworks that take financial linkages between firms as exogenously given.

The Externalities of Going Public (with Sonakshi Agrawal)

We document spillovers to peer firms' cost of capital and price informativeness arising from IPO completions in the United States. Exploiting a stacked difference-in-difference design, we show that when a firm successfully completes an IPO, its existing public peers experience a significant decrease in the cost of equity. We are in the process of developing a theoretical model which embeds various mechanisms like signaling through IPO completion, enhanced information production, and changes in investor attention. The model will be disciplined using empirically identified moments, including the cost of capital and a rich set of information measures. We further use the model to explore the macroeconomic implications of the well-documented listings gap. Taken together, our findings identify a previously underexplored externality of IPO activity and underscore its importance beyond the issuing firm.

Standardized Test Scores in U.S. College Admissions (with Navin Kartik)

In this work, we study how US Colleges use test scores from multiple attempts on standardized tests. Allowing students to improve their score by retesting provides more data about their ability. However, many talented students do not have the financial resources to test multiple times. Given this tradeoff, we use a mechanism design approach to characterize the optimal incentive-compatible mechanism to combine scores for a wide class of payoff functions for the College. We show that in general, the optimal mechanism may not resemble any of the commonly used mechanisms like the most recent score or highest score. We derive two sets of sufficient conditions – one for the optimal mechanism to take the form of average score and second for the optimal mechanism to take the form of most recent score.

AWARDS AND HONORS

Wueller Fellowship for Best Teaching Fellows (Runner-up), Columbia University	2024
Summer Research Fellowship, Program of Economic Research, Columbia University	2023
Dean's Fellowship, Columbia University	2022
President's Award (Top 1%), American Express	2019
Innovation Award, Risk Management, American Express	2017
Gymkhana Blues for exemplary leadership in student governance, IIT Kanpur	2014
All India Rank 302 (Top 0.1%), IIT-JEE	2009

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Columbia University

Instructor

Money and Banking (Undergraduate Course) — Summer 2025

Teaching Assistant

Corporate Finance	Spring 2026
Empirical Macroeconomics and Finance	Fall 2025
Macroeconomic Analysis II (M.A.)	Spring 2025
Intermediate Macroeconomics	Fall 2024
Macroeconomics II (Ph.D.)	Spring 2024
Microeconomic Analysis I (M.A.)	Fall 2023

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

American Express, New York, NY

Senior Manager, Risk Management	Oct 2017 – Jul 2019
Manager, Risk Management	Dec 2015 – Sep 2017

Fuzzy Logix LLC, Charlotte, NC

Data Scientist	Jul 2014 – Dec 2015

REFERENCES

Jennifer La'O
Associate Professor
Department of Economics
Columbia University
jenlao@columbia.edu

Laura Veldkamp
Professor
Finance Division
Columbia Business School
lv2405@columbia.edu

Hassan Afrouzi
Associate Professor
Department of Economics
Columbia University
ha2475@columbia.edu